

The Canadian Investor's Guide: Toronto to Dubai

Canada tax comparison · Three emirates · Financing · Currency strategy · Updated July 2026

AED 419.9B DUBAI H1 2026 TRANSACTIONS	0% INCOME & CAPITAL GAINS TAX	6.58% DUBAI AVG GROSS YIELD
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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Canada's federal foreign-buyer ban runs to January 2027, with Ontario's 25% non-resident speculation tax on top — while Dubai recorded AED 419.9 billion in H1 2026 transactions and offers full freehold ownership to Canadians with zero restrictions and zero tax on income or gains.

CANADA VS UAE: THE TAX COMPARISON

Tax type	Canada	UAE	Advantage
Income tax on rentals	15–33% federal + 5–21% provincial	0%	Keep 100% of rent
Capital gains tax	50–66% inclusion	0%	No tax on sale profits
Foreign buyer rules	Federal ban to 2027 + ON 25% NRST	No restrictions	Buy freely
Speculation/vacancy tax	1–3% annual	0%	No penalty taxes
Annual property tax	0.5–2.5%	0%	No holding cost
Net rental yield	~2–4%	5–6.5%	~2x net income

THREE EMIRATES FOR CANADIAN CAPITAL

Emirate	Entry/sqft	Gross yield	Catalyst	Best for
Dubai	AED 1,300–4,200+	6.5–8%	Al Maktoum Airport, Dubai 2040	Liquidity & depth
Abu Dhabi	AED 900–2,500	5–7%	Saadiyat Cultural District	Stability & yield
Ras Al Khaimah	AED 1,000–1,600	7–9%	Wynn Al Marjan, Spring 2027	Highest yield

CURRENCY & RESIDENCY

The AED's USD peg (3.6725) removes emerging-market currency risk — unlike CAD, which fluctuates with oil and rates. 10-year Golden Visa requires property worth AED 2M+ (since Feb 2026, off-plan qualifies on the registered Oqood price — no minimum paid equity; mortgaged properties qualify with a bank NOC). Properties from AED 750K qualify for a 2-year renewable residence visa (Taskeen).

THE BOTTOM LINE

Blocked at home by policy, taxed at every layer — Canadian capital gets neither yield nor welcome in Toronto. The UAE offers both, with a USD-pegged currency and a market that just posted its second-best half ever.

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